

DAILY DEVOTIONS FOR THE HUNGRY SOUL

WAKE UP

JOHN 3:1-2 DAY 1 OF 7

Nicodemus by Night

A Pharisee comes in the dark with a question he cannot ask in daylight. Jesus does not turn him away.

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Today + 7 Days

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John

ANCHOR SCRIPTURE

Now there was a Pharisee, a man named Nicodemus who was a member of the Jewish ruling council. He came to Jesus *at night* and said, ‘*Rabbi, we know* that you are a teacher who has come from God. For no one could perform the signs you are doing if God were not with him.’

JOHN 3:1-2 (NIV)

at night Rabbi we know

οὗτος ἦλθεν πρὸς αὐτὸν νυκτὸς

houtos ēlthen pros auton nuktos — ‘this one came to him by night’

Job

OLD TESTAMENT ECHO

There are those who rebel against the light, who do not know its ways or stay in its paths. When daylight is gone, the murderer rises up, kills the poor and needy, and in the night steals forth like a thief.

JOB 24:13-14 (NIV)

Job names the night as the cover of those whose deeds will not bear daylight. Nicodemus is not Job’s night-rebel — but he comes wearing the same darkness, and Jesus does not refuse him for it.

HONEST-EXAMINATION

Reflection

What is the question you have not yet asked out loud?

Who knows you came here today, and who does not?

Take a moment. Notice that the question itself does not disqualify you from the conversation.

Nicodemus came at night, and Jesus answered him.

PRAYER (personal)

Posture: honest

*Lord, *I have come at night. *I have come carrying what I cannot
carry in daylight. You did not turn Nicodemus away. Do not turn
me away. Meet me in the room where I came in, and let the
conversation begin where I am. — *Amen. **

BREATH PRAYER

*Breathe in: *I have come at night. *Breathe out: *He does not turn me away. **

STORYTIME



The Letter He Could Not Send

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"Open Bible by Lamplight" – Generated, 2026

Lamp in the dark – the secret seeker's posture, returning to the text by night.

GREEK G3571

vukṭì

/nukti/ (nik-TEE)

by night, at night

John uses night-language at three pivots in his Gospel: when Nicodemus comes (3:2), when Judas goes out to betray (*kai ēn nyx*, 13:30), and when Mary Magdalene comes to the empty tomb *while it was still dark* (20:1). Night in John is the moment something secret is moving — and the text watches to see whether it is the secret of betrayal or the secret of seeking.

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*John 3:2's *nuktos* is the same root in genitive (the time *during which* something occurs) — a small grammatical variation but the same theological note. Nicodemus's night is John's quiet signal: pay attention, something is in motion.*

RELATED

ἀμὴν — truly, firmly, so be it — Jesus opens His reply to Nicodemus with the doubled form, *amēn amēn* (3:3). The doubled *amēn* in John signals a saying of unusual weight.

פרושי — Hebrew/Aramaic 'Pharisee' — literally 'separated one,' the school of Torah-keepers committed to applying purity-laws to daily life. Nicodemus's identity as a *perushi* makes his night-coming costlier.

BIBLEPROJECT – THE GOSPEL OF JOHN (SERIES OVERVIEW)



BibleProject's overview of John's Gospel sets the cathedral structure inside which the Nicodemus conversation lives. Watch this once at the start of the week and the rest of the seven days will sit on it.

THIS WEEK'S JOURNEY

This is Day 1 of 7.

Today, we have met Nicodemus at the door of the conversation. He has come at night, with credentials, with a careful plural — *we know*. Jesus has not turned him away. The room is open.

Tomorrow, we will hear Jesus' first answer: *unless one is born from above (γεννηθῇ ἄνωθεν, gennēthē anōthen), they cannot see the kingdom of God.* It is the answer that makes Nicodemus's careful credentials irrelevant — and gives him a way through them.

[CONTINUE TO TOMORROW →](#)

Have an hour and want the whole week now? The deep dive holds the entire conversation — John 3:1–21, full PaRDeS, Hebrew & Greek paired with transliteration, OT roots, NT echoes, references.

[CONTINUE TO THE DEEP DIVE →](#)

Finished reading? Mark this day complete.

WAKE UP

